Online Learning Impact Analysis

A Project Work Synopsis

Submitted in the partial fulfilment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

IN

COMPUTER SCIENCE WITH SPECIALIZATION IN

BIG DATA ANALYTICS

Submitted by:
22BDA70035 RAJ SIGNH
22BDA70032 ANMOL RANA
22BDA70030 GAUTAM SINGLA
22BDA70006 SIDHARTH PUNDIR

Under the Supervision of:

DR. AMARDEEP SINGH

CHANDIGARH UNIVERSITY, GHARUAN, MOHALI - 140413,

PUNJAB

JANUARY, 2026

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ABSTRACT

The blistering development of online learning sites has drastically changed the current education by providing flexibility, accessibility, and the availability of various learning materials. Academic learning, mastering of skills, and examination preparation are all becoming more digitalized among the students. Nevertheless, the usage of online learning among students is an unequal tool with students exhibiting varying levels of efficiency in online learning based on their learning patterns, level of participation, frequency of use, and the learning environment.

The suggested project is an **online learning impact analysis of students**, which attempts to determine the learning patterns, the frequency of usage, and the perceived effectiveness of online learning platforms by a data-driven approach. The structured survey on Google Forms will be used to gather primary data. Data retrieved will be washed and analysed with Python and Microsoft Excel and knowledge will be visualised with the help of Power BI dashboards. Simple statistical methods including descriptive examination and correlation will be used to determine meaningful patterns and trends.

The final product of the project will be a detailed analytical report with interactive visualizations, which will present practically applicable information on the engagement of the students and the effectiveness of online learning tools. Such observations can help institutions of learning and creators of platforms enhance their digital learning programs.

Keywords: *Online Learning, Student Learning Patterns, Usage Frequency, Learning Effectiveness, Google Forms, Python, Power BI, Data Analytics*

INTRODUCTION

Online learning has become an integral component of modern education systems due to advancements in digital technologies and internet accessibility [1]. Educational institutions increasingly rely on online platforms to supplement classroom teaching and provide flexible learning opportunities.

Despite widespread adoption, Scopus-indexed research highlights that online learning effectiveness is inconsistent across student groups. Studies report that while some learners benefit from self-paced digital learning, others experience reduced engagement due to distractions, lack of interaction, and poor self-regulation [2], [3]. These findings emphasize that learning outcomes are influenced more by engagement quality and learning behaviour than by platform usage alone.

Recent systematic reviews suggest that institutions often lack structured, data-driven mechanisms to evaluate how students interact with online learning platforms and whether these interactions translate into meaningful learning outcomes [1], [4]. This creates a need for analytical studies that examine learning patterns, usage frequency, and perceived effectiveness in online education environments.

1.1 Problem Definition

In spite of the high adoption of online learning platforms, institutions do not have a structured and data-driven understanding of the way students use these platforms and their effectiveness in facilitating learning outcomes [1]. Studies have shown that increased use of online platforms does not always lead to better learning because of discontinuity in learning, multitasking, distractors and effects of digital platforms and passive learning behaviour [2], [3].

Recent Scopus-indexed publications underscore the fact that engagement quality, self-regulated learning, and a regular study routine are important determinants of the success of online learning [2]. Nevertheless, informal feedback is utilized in many institutions, and prevents the possibility to define efficient learning patterns and proactive response to learning issues [4].

This brings out the necessity of data-intensive analytical methodology in assessing the learning behaviour in students, the frequency of using the online learning platforms, and how effective they perceive the online learning platforms to be.

Key Problems Identified:

- **Lack of structured insight into student learning patterns:** Institutions do not have reliable data to understand how students use online learning platforms.

- **Unclear relationship between usage and effectiveness:** Higher time spent on online platforms does not always result in better learning outcomes.

- **Low measurement of student satisfaction and engagement:** Student feedback is often informal and not analysed statistically.

- **Limited identification of learning challenges:** Common issues such as distractions, lack of interaction, and motivation are not systematically studied.

- **Absence of data-driven improvements:** Online learning strategies are rarely optimized based on analytical insights.

1.2 Problem Overview

The Online Learning Impact Analysis project is expected to research the impact of online learning platforms on students based on analysis of their learning patterns, frequency of use, and perceived effectiveness of online learning. This is in line with the suggestions made by Scopus-indexed studies in the recent past that insist on behavioral-level analysis instead of surface-level usage metrics [1], [4].

Primary data shall be gathered by use of structured questionnaire generated in Google Forms. The gathered information will be scrubbed with Microsoft Excel and processed with Python with simple statistical procedures. The learning patterns and the engagement trends will be presented in visualization forms with the help of Power BI dashboards to make the information clear, as it is implied in the current learning analytics literature [4].

The project bridges the gaps in current Scopus-indexed research that largely concentrate on general effectiveness patterns and not underlying learning behaviors

[2], [3] due to the emphasis on behavioral aspects (i.e., fragmented learning sessions and consistency of engagement).

The project ultimately aims to provide actionable insights that can contribute to improving the design and implementation of online learning systems.

🔎 **Key Challenges in the Current Landscape:**

- **Inconsistent online learning engagement:** Student participation and engagement levels vary significantly across different online learning platforms.

- **Lack of personalized learning experiences:** Most platforms follow a one-size-fits-all approach that does not adapt to individual learning styles or pace.

- **No standardized framework for identifying trends or comparing groups:** There is no unified method for comparing mental health across college types (government, private, autonomous), academic streams, genders, or year of study. Without such segmentation, high-risk groups remain invisible within the broader student body.

- **Difficulty in maintaining learner motivation:** The absence of direct instructor interaction often leads to reduced focus and self-discipline among students.

- **Limited monitoring of learning effectiveness:** Institutions lack mechanisms to measure whether online learning actually improves academic understanding.
- **Distractions and time-management issues:** Home-based learning environments and digital distractions negatively impact students' study routines.
- **Insufficient feedback and support systems:** Students often receive delayed or inadequate feedback, affecting learning continuity.
- **Absence of data-driven decision making:** Improvements in online education are rarely guided by systematic analysis of student data.

1.3 Hardware Specification

The hardware requirements for this project are minimal, as it primarily involves data collection, analysis, and visualization.

Recommended Hardware:

💻 A laptop or desktop (minimum 4 GB RAM, dual-core processor).

🌐 Stable internet connection (for survey distribution and dashboard use).

🖥 Monitor (1366x768 or higher for dashboard clarity).

💾 External or cloud storage (e.g., Google Drive or USB) for backup.

1.4 Software Specification

The project leverages freely available or institutionally accessible software for survey creation, data analysis, and visualization.

Software Tools Used:

📋 **Google Forms** - To design and distribute the survey to students.

📊 **Microsoft Excel / Google Sheets** - For data cleaning and statistical analysis.

🐍 **Python** - For statistical analysis and data processing

📈 **Power BI / Tableau** - To visualize the survey results via interactive dashboards.

☁ **Google Drive** - For collaborative file sharing and real-time updates.

📝 **MS Word** - For documentation and report generation.

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